

THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE OIL CHOKEPOINT RISK THESIS

The Price Of Passage

Brent settled at \$88.79 a barrel on 11 August, roughly 30 per cent below the \$126.41 it touched intraday on 30 April. Over the same stretch the Strait of Hormuz has not reopened. It has closed further. Traffic through the strait averaged 4.9 million barrels a day in the second quarter, against 21.6 million in the last quarter of 2025. On 31 July the Iranian authority governing Gulf waterways declared a complete suspension of ship movement.

A crude price falling while its principal artery narrows is not a contradiction. It is a signal about where the scarcity has moved.

A reframe worth holding onto

An oil shock is usually read as a shortage of barrels. This one is better read as a shortage of safe voyages. The barrels have largely found their way to market — by pipeline across Saudi Arabia, by longer sea routes, by drawing down inventories. What has not been replaced is the cheap, insurable, forty-day passage from the Gulf to Asia.

On that reading the scarcity rent does not sit with the producer. It sits with whoever owns a hull and whoever writes the cover on it.

Method. Every figure in this edition is external and dated: prices from Trading Economics and Baltic Exchange assessments, balances from the IEA Oil Market Report and the US Energy Information Administration Short-Term Energy Outlook, company figures from issuers' own quarterly releases. Where two authoritative sources disagree, both are given and the disagreement is left standing. **This edition carries no internal Heyokha Wiki view.** The Wiki MCP server was not enabled in this automated session, so no provider-attributed research was available; the sidebar reframe above is the editor's own, built from external reporting, and should not be read as a house position. See "Limitation on the internal view" on the final page.

Picture a town at the head of a steep valley, reached by one road bridge. One winter the bridge is judged unsafe and the police close it. Prices in the town triple within a fortnight — bread, fuel, timber, everything. Then the hauliers adapt. They find a forestry track over the shoulder of the mountain: slower, narrower, but passable. They buy heavier lorries with reinforced axles. The insurer, who now knows the route, quotes forty times the old premium for the run. Within three months the shelves in the town are stocked again and the price of bread has fallen most of the way back to where it started. The bridge, meanwhile, is still shut. Nothing about the bridge got better. What changed is that the town learned to live without it — at a cost that is paid, every single load, to the man who owns the heavy lorries and the man who underwrites them. The baker is no richer than he was. The haulier has never had a year like it.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

\$88.79

Brent crude, close of 11 August 2026, up 1.22 per cent on the day. Against \$72.48 on 27 February, the session before the war began, and \$126.41 at the intraday peak on 30 April.

Trading Economics, 11 August 2026; countryeconomy.com daily series.

4.9 mb/d

Crude and products transiting the Strait of Hormuz, second-quarter 2026 average, against 21.6 million barrels a day in the fourth quarter of 2025. Roughly one barrel in five of the old flow.

EIA Short-Term Energy Outlook, 11 August 2026.

\$481,286

Daily round-trip earnings on the benchmark Middle East Gulf to China very large crude carrier route (TD3C), assessed 7 August 2026. The pre-war assessment on 27 February was \$208,000.

Baltic Exchange, 7 August 2026; Platts, 27 February 2026.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

A blockade that stopped moving the price

The sequence matters, because the market has repriced it three times. On 28 February a United States and Israeli military campaign against Iran began. Iran closed the Strait of Hormuz in response, and the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps signalled that no ship would be allowed to pass. Roughly a fifth of global petroleum consumption normally moves through that channel — 20.7 million barrels a day in 2024 on the EIA's count, alongside some 11.4 billion cubic feet a day of liquefied natural gas. Brent went from \$72.48 on 27 February to a \$126.41 intraday print on 30 April, and American pump prices reached \$4.30 a gallon.

The second repricing came in June. A memorandum of understanding signed on 17 June reopened the strait the following day, and the American blockade of Iranian ports was lifted. Gulf oil exports jumped 6.5 million barrels a day in June to 16.1 million, still well short of the roughly 24 million that moved before the war. Brent averaged \$85.40 in June, having averaged \$117.29 in April. The market treated the reopening as the end of the episode.

It was not. Strikes resumed on 13 July, Iran said it had hit two tankers, and the United States reinstated the port blockade on 14 July. By the last week of July, Lloyd's List Intelligence was recording non-Iranian-linked transits down roughly ninety per cent on the year, with around seventy per cent of tanker movements running with transponders switched off. On 31 July Iran declared a complete suspension of ship movement. Early in August, Iran and Oman agreed in principle on temporary shipping lanes — inbound through Iranian waters near Larak Island, outbound along the Omani coast — but no agreement had been signed as of 11 August, and Iran has continued to insist it negotiates with Muscat rather than Washington.

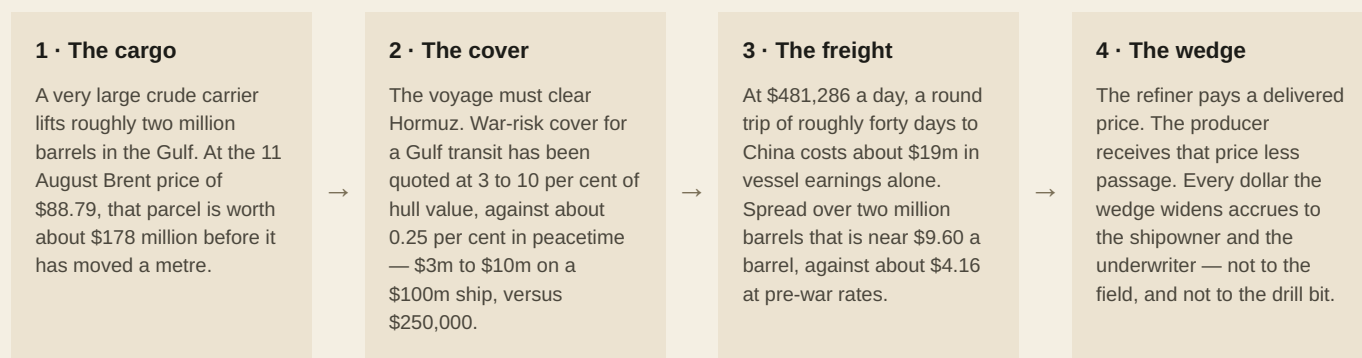
The third repricing is the one that is difficult to see and easy to misread. Through all of that escalation, Brent has traded in the \$80s. It did so because the physical system adapted faster than anyone expected. Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline, designed for five million barrels a day, has been run at seven. Flows through Bab el-Mandeb rose from 5.4 million barrels a day in the fourth quarter of 2025 to 8.1 million in the second quarter of 2026 as cargoes were rerouted. IEA member governments released some 400 million barrels of emergency stocks. And demand did what demand does when petrol costs \$4.48 a gallon: it fell. The IEA's July report has global consumption *contracting* by around a million barrels a day in 2026 — the first annual decline since 2020.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

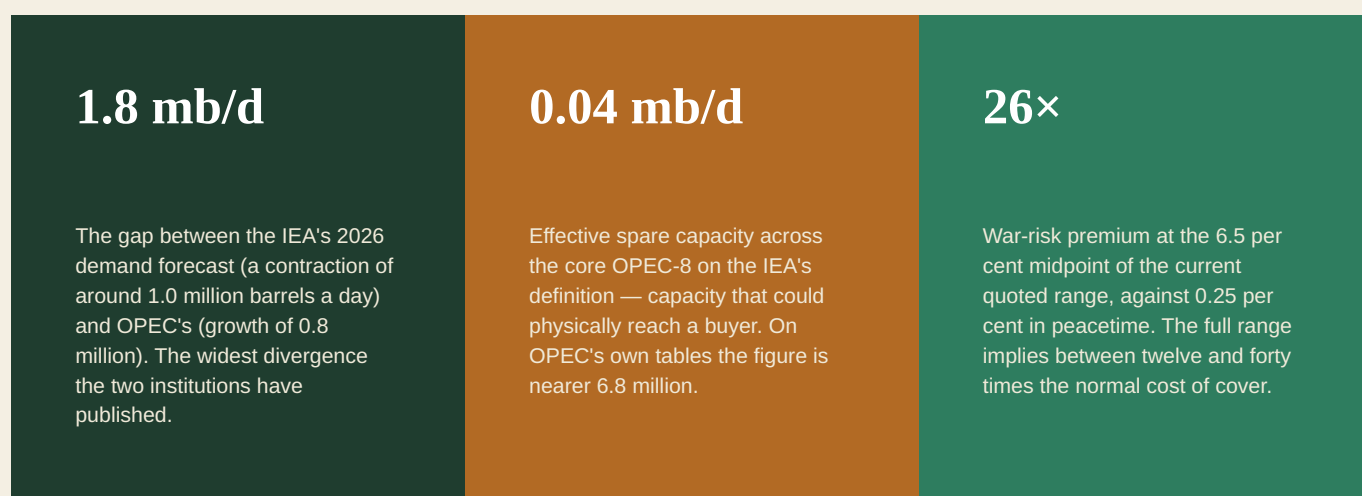
Spare capacity is not a quantity of oil. It is a quantity of oil that can reach a buyer. The IEA puts effective spare capacity across the core OPEC-8 at 0.04 million barrels a day. OPEC's own monthly tables imply close to seven million. Both are arithmetically defensible; the difference is whether you count barrels sitting behind a closed strait. *Only one of those two numbers can be loaded onto a ship.*

THE MECHANISM

Where the money goes on a single cargo



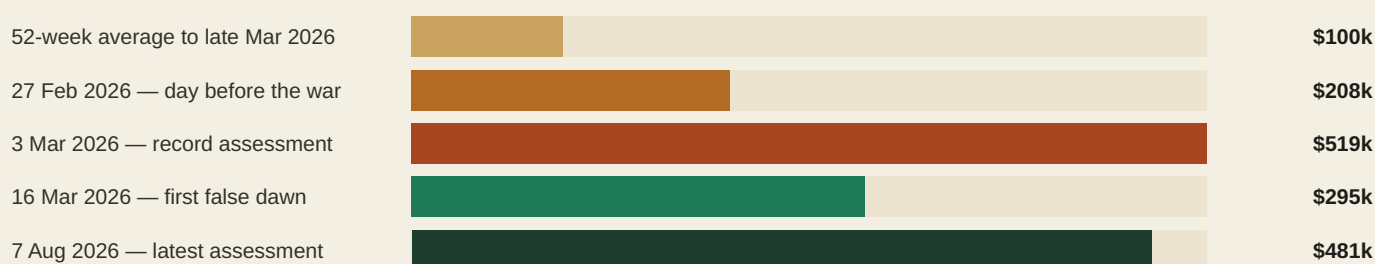
Cargo size and voyage duration are conventional benchmark assumptions; the per-barrel freight figures are this guide's own arithmetic applied to sourced day rates, not a published assessment. Day rates: Baltic Exchange TD3C, 7 August 2026, and Platts, 27 February 2026. Insurance range: Marcus Baker, Global Head of Marine at Marsh, quoted in The National, 17 July 2026. Brent: Trading Economics, 11 August 2026.



IEA Oil Market Report, July 2026 (published 10 July 2026), with 2026 demand and supply figures as reported by Argus, 10 July 2026. OPEC Monthly Oil Market Report, July 2026 (published 13 July 2026). War-risk premiums: Marsh via The National, 17 July 2026; midpoint calculated by this guide.

THE CENTRAL COMPARISON

The voyage did not get cheaper



Very large crude carrier daily earnings, Middle East Gulf to China round trip (TD3C). Bars are illustrative and scaled to the highest value shown; they are not a continuous time series and the intervals between dates are unequal. Sources: Baltic Exchange, 7 August 2026; Platts VLCC index, 27 February, 3 March and 16 March 2026; 52-week average from Signal Group, week 14 2026. For contrast, Brent fell from a \$126.41 intraday peak on 30 April to \$88.79 on 11 August. 2025 was already a strong tanker year, so the gap to the 52-week average overstates the pure war premium.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

Price the chokepoint, not the commodity. In a blockade the barrel is rarely scarce for long; the safe passage is, because you cannot drill a new one. *Whoever owns the passage collects the rent, and collects it whether the barrel is worth sixty dollars or a hundred and twenty.*

WHAT HAS ACTUALLY SHIFTED

Four changes, each cutting both ways

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
Ton-miles, not barrels, became the binding constraint	Hormuz transit 4.9 mb/d in Q2 against 21.6 mb/d in Q4 2025; Bab el-Mandeb up from 5.4 to 8.1 mb/d as cargoes rerouted. Asian refiners now source replacement barrels from the Atlantic basin rather than the Gulf.	Longer voyages absorb tonnage and support rates for as long as the detour lasts. They also end abruptly. A signed Hormuz agreement shortens every route at once, and the tanker market has no inventory to cushion the reversal.
Demand fell rather than supply being replaced	The IEA has 2026 consumption contracting around 1.0 mb/d to 103.3 mb/d, the first annual decline since 2020, with second-quarter demand down roughly 5 mb/d year on year.	Demand destruction is what capped the price — genuinely bearish for crude. But destroyed demand tends to return when prices fall, which is precisely what makes the 2027 balance look loose and the 2026 balance still tight.
OPEC+ has run out of both cuts and cushion	The 2 August meeting approved a further 188 kb/d for September, completing the rollback of the 1.65 mb/d of April 2023 voluntary cuts. The IEA puts remaining effective OPEC-8 spare capacity at 0.04 mb/d.	No cushion means any fresh outage goes straight into the price. It also means the group has no lever left to defend a price on the way down, and roughly 2 mb/d of older cuts still stand to be unwound.
The forecasting institutions stopped agreeing	OPEC sees 2026 demand growing 0.8 mb/d; the IEA sees it shrinking around 1.0 mb/d. The EIA, splitting the difference, has Brent averaging \$87 in 2026 and \$69 in 2027.	A 1.8 mb/d spread between the two most-cited balances means the consensus number quoted in any given article is close to arbitrary. It also means positioning is unusually uncrowded — nobody can claim the data is on their side.

BULL AND BEAR, STATED FAIRLY

The case each way

The case for the chokepoint trade

- **The disruption is deepening, not healing.** Iran declared a complete suspension of ship movement on 31 July and the Oman lanes deal was unsigned as of 11 August. Transits ran at seven to eight a day in early August, against roughly 130 before the crisis.
- **The rates are realised, not forecast.** International Seaways posted its best quarter in a near ten-year history on 6 August — \$294.9m, \$5.91 a share — on blended spot earnings of \$79,000 a day against \$27,500 a year earlier.
- **The forward book is already fixed.** DHT had 58 per cent of third-quarter spot days booked at \$152,700 a day. Frontline disclosed 82 per cent of its second-quarter VLCC days fixed at \$181,700, against \$103,500 realised in the first.
- **Nothing is left to absorb a shock.** Effective OPEC-8 spare capacity is 0.04 mb/d on the IEA's definition. Saudi Arabia is already running its East-West line at 7 mb/d against a 5 mb/d design, and the next bypass increment is a 2027 project.
- **The balance sheets are clean.** Teekay ended the quarter with roughly \$1.3bn of liquidity and no debt; DHT's net debt was \$273.1m against \$198.3m of quarterly earnings. This is a cycle being paid out, not levered into.

The case against it

- **The official forecasts point down, hard.** The EIA's 11 August outlook has Brent at \$85 in the third quarter, \$78 in the fourth and \$69 across 2027. Fitch, on 8 August, saw roughly \$70 by the fourth quarter and oversupply from September.
- **A deal is the whole thesis in reverse.** Wood Mackenzie's Simon Flowers and Alan Gelder argued on 3 August that under a credible agreement Brent sinks well below \$60 into 2027. Ton-mile demand would not decay; it would collapse.
- **The recovery is already assumed.** J.P. Morgan's mid-July work has Gulf supply at roughly 90 per cent of pre-war volumes in August and 97 per cent by October, with a first surplus of about 1.2 mb/d in August.
- **Guided rates are falling, from the issuers themselves.** International Seaways guided third-quarter bookings at roughly \$61,000 a day against \$79,000 realised; Teekay's Aframax at \$59,900 against \$74,149. The peak is in their own disclosure.
- **Demand is impaired and the base flatters.** A 1.0 mb/d annual contraction is no rounding error, and the roughly 5 mb/d surplus the IEA sketches for 2027 would swamp any freight story. Measuring \$481,000 against a \$100,000 average also overstates the war premium.

The disagreement this edition does not resolve

The format normally reserves this section for a conflict between the internal Wiki view and external reporting. That comparison cannot be made today, because no internal view was retrievable. What can be reported is a conflict between external authorities that is sharper than any house disagreement is likely to be.

The IEA and OPEC do not agree on the direction of oil demand in 2026. The IEA's July report has consumption *falling* by around a million barrels a day; OPEC's, published three days later, has it *rising* by 0.8 million. That is a spread of roughly 1.8 million barrels a day on the single most important number in the market, and it is the widest the two have published. The same institutions also disagree about spare capacity, and for a reason that is conceptual rather than statistical: OPEC counts Gulf capacity that is shut in behind a closed strait, and the IEA does not. Depending on which convention is used, the world has either almost no cushion or a very comfortable one.

Both readings are visible in the price. Brent at \$88.79 is neither the \$120 a genuinely uncushioned market would imply nor the \$60s a 2027-surplus consensus would discount to. The market appears to be holding both stories at once and waiting for the Hormuz negotiation to pick one. This edition does not know which, and offers no view on it. Note too that the IEA's August report and OPEC's August report were both scheduled for release on 12 August and were not public at the time of writing — the figures above are the July vintage and are a month stale in a fast-moving war market.

WHAT TO WATCH FROM HERE

Six signals

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
A signed Iran–Oman lanes agreement	Agreed in principle on 5–6 August; coordinates settled, joint statement still being drafted, and reported to need sign-off from Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei.	The single binary in the whole complex. A signature shortens every voyage in the Gulf trade simultaneously and removes the war-risk premium at a stroke.
Baltic Dirty Tanker Index	2,644 on 10 August, roughly double where it began the year, against a peak of 3,723 on 30 March.	The cleanest daily read on whether freight is still being bid. It will turn before any company reports it, and before the crude price reflects it.
Third-quarter fixture disclosure	DHT 58 per cent booked at \$152,700; International Seaways roughly 48 per cent at \$61,000 blended; Teekay Suezmaxes 44 per cent at \$104,800.	These are contracted, not forecast. The direction of the next round of bookings is the most reliable near-term evidence available on where the cycle sits.
Frontline's second-quarter result, 31 August	The largest listed pure tanker operator has not yet reported the quarter. It guided 82 per cent of VLCC days fixed at \$181,700.	The last unreported check on whether the second quarter was as good across the sector as the reporters suggest, and the first look at management's third-quarter tone.
The IEA and OPEC August reports	Both scheduled for 12 August and unpublished at the time of writing. The July vintages differ by 1.8 mb/d on 2026 demand.	If the gap narrows, one institution has capitulated and the market gains an anchor. If it widens, the most-quoted balance in oil is less informative than it looks.

US July CPI, and the September FOMC

July CPI was due at 08:30 New York time on 12 August; consensus 3.4 per cent headline. June energy fell 5.7 per cent on the month but was still up 15.7 per cent on the year. The Fed held at 3.50–3.75 per cent on 29 July, 9–3, with three dissents for a *hike*.

Energy is now the swing factor in the American inflation print. A hot number revives a September hike and tightens financial conditions into a market already long geopolitical risk.

THREE POSTURES, NOT ONE ANSWER

Coherent ways to hold this, and what each costs

Own the passage

Take the view that the chokepoint rent persists, and express it in tanker equity, where the cash is being earned and distributed now rather than promised. **The cost:** this is a single-headline position. A signed Hormuz agreement removes the entire thesis in a session, and the sector has no defensive characteristics to fall back on — freight rates have no floor beneath operating cost.

Own the barrel

Take the view that a market with 0.04 mb/d of usable spare capacity cannot stay in the \$80s, and express it through integrated producers with the balance sheet to survive being early. **The cost:** you are betting against the EIA, Fitch and BMI, all of whom published a declining path in the past fortnight. You also carry demand risk the freight trade does not.

Own neither, and wait

Take the view that a 1.8 mb/d disagreement between the IEA and OPEC is a statement about how little anyone knows, and hold the exposure until the August reports and the Hormuz negotiation resolve. **The cost:** the realised earnings are being paid out as dividends this quarter, not next. Waiting for clarity in a cyclical is usually waiting for the cash to have been distributed to somebody else.

The companies named below are illustrative of the mechanics discussed in this edition. They are NOT recommendations, and no view is expressed on the merits of any security. Figures are drawn from issuers' own published results and from dated market assessments.

DHT

\$18.33 · 11 Aug 2026

DHT Holdings · 23 VLCCs · Q2 reported 5 Aug 2026

The purest listed expression of the VLCC spot market. Second-quarter revenue of \$285.0m produced net income of \$198.3m and earnings of \$1.23 a share, on spot earnings of \$162,600 a day and a fleet average of \$126,700. The board declared \$1.22 a share — a sixty-sixth consecutive quarterly dividend, distributing very nearly the whole quarter's earnings. Management says hostilities are "forcing longer trade routes, increasing ton-mile demand and reducing overall fleet efficiency", and that those "venturing into the Persian Gulf are earning substantial risk premiums".

WATCH NEXT

Whether the next tranche of third-quarter fixtures prices above or below the \$152,700 a day already booked on 58 per cent of spot days.

INSW

\$89.06 · 11 Aug 2026

International Seaways · crude and products · Q2 reported 6 Aug 2026

The clearest illustration of the scale of the move. Net income of \$294.9m and diluted earnings of \$5.91 a share were, on the company's own description, the highest quarterly result in its near ten-year history. Blended fleet-wide spot earnings were \$79,000 a day against \$27,500 a year earlier, and the board declared \$5.05 a share, taking the trailing year to \$12.61. Chief executive Lois Zabrocky called the Hormuz conflict "one of the most significant disruptions to seaborne transportation that we have seen in decades".

WATCH NEXT

Third-quarter guidance of roughly \$61,000 a day blended on 48 per cent of days booked — well below the \$79,000 realised. The deceleration is already disclosed.

TNK

\$76.21 · 10 Aug 2026

Teekay Tankers · 14 Suezmax, 18 Aframax/LR2 · Q2 reported 29 Jul 2026

The mid-size expression, and the most conservatively financed. Revenue of \$379.5m yielded GAAP net income of \$225.9m, or \$6.49 a share, with adjusted earnings of \$5.56. Suezmax spot earnings of \$109,171 a day and Aframax/LR2 of \$74,149 were, management said, the highest in the company's history, driven by "the effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz". It ended the quarter with roughly \$1.3bn of liquidity and no debt, yet kept its fixed dividend at \$0.25 — a strikingly different distribution policy from its peers.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the retained cash is deployed into secondhand tonnage at cycle-peak values, or held. The two outcomes have very different consequences.

FRO

\$38.14 · 11 Aug 2026

Frontline plc · the unreported quarter · Q2 due 31 Aug 2026

The largest listed tanker operator has not yet reported the June quarter; the figures here are first-quarter, reported 22 May. Revenue of \$714.2m gave net income of \$559.1m and adjusted earnings of \$1.55 a share, on VLCC spot earnings of \$103,500 a day. The forward disclosure is the interesting part: 82 per cent of second-quarter VLCC days were then fixed at \$181,700. Chief executive Lars Barstad noted that removing a fifth of seaborne oil exports was expected to weaken the market, but that longer lanes and inefficiency instead supported utilisation.

WATCH NEXT

The 31 August result is the last unreported read on the peak quarter, and the first on management's third-quarter tone.

SHEL

\$90.50 ADR · 11 Aug 2026

Shell plc · the integrated counterweight · Q2 reported 30 Jul 2026

Included because it shows the barrel side of the same disruption, and its limits. Adjusted earnings of \$9,836m and free cash flow of \$17.5bn came on realised liquids of \$89 a barrel against \$72 in the first quarter. But the Middle East cuts both ways within one company: Integrated Gas production fell to 631 thousand barrels of oil equivalent a day from 909, a 31 per cent decline the company attributed to the conflict's effect on Qatari volumes. Refining rescued the quarter — an indicative margin of \$24 a barrel against \$17, at a record 102 per cent utilisation.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Qatari LNG volumes recover in the third quarter. That single line has moved more of Shell's earnings mix than the crude price has.

VLO

\$323.92 · 11 Aug 2026

Valero Energy · the refined-product link · Q2 reported 30 Jul 2026

The third link in the chain, and this year's largest beneficiary of it. Revenue of \$44.476bn produced net income of \$3.7bn and earnings of \$12.62 a share, with refining operating income of \$4.470bn against \$1.3bn a year earlier, on a margin of \$23.62 per barrel and 2,950 thousand barrels a day processed. The driver is not crude but capacity: an estimated 4.5 million barrels a day of refining capacity went offline in the quarter. Chief operating officer Gary Simmons said recovery depends on Middle Eastern operations normalising.

WATCH NEXT

The US 3:2:1 crack spread, \$60.04 on 10 August against a record \$64.58 on 8 July. Returning capacity compresses it from the supply side.

The bottom line

What was repriced this year was not the barrel. Brent is \$88.79, about 23 per cent above where it stood the day before the war and roughly 30 per cent below its April peak — a substantial move, but a recognisable one. What was repriced beyond recognition was the passage. Very large crude carrier earnings on the Gulf-to-China route are \$481,286 a day against \$208,000 the day before the campaign began, and war-risk cover for a Gulf transit runs at twelve to forty times its peacetime cost. The oil found its way to market. The cheap voyage did not come back, and the companies that own hulls have reported the best quarters in their corporate histories while the crude price fell.

The evidence is genuinely mixed on what happens next, and it is worth being explicit about that. The realised numbers are unambiguous and the forward numbers are not: every tanker operator that has reported has also disclosed third-quarter bookings below what it realised in the second, and the EIA, Fitch and BMI have all published declining price paths within the past fortnight. Against that, effective spare capacity is 0.04 million barrels a day on the IEA's count and the strait is still shut. The reasonable inference is that this is a rent with a visible expiry date rather than a structural repricing — the question is not whether it ends but whether it ends in September or in 2027. The next test is specific and near: a signed Iran–Oman lanes agreement, which would answer the question in a single session, and failing that the IEA and OPEC August reports, which will show whether the two institutions are converging on a view of demand or drifting further apart.

Editorial note. This document is educational commentary prepared for internal use at Heyokha Brothers. It is not investment advice, not a recommendation, and not an offer or solicitation in respect of any security. Companies are named only to illustrate the mechanics under discussion; no view is expressed on the merits of any security, and readers should not infer a position from inclusion. All external figures are attributed and carry an as-of date; market data moves and any figure here may be stale by the time it is read. Internal Heyokha Wiki views, where present in this format, are the named research providers' opinions and are labelled as views rather than forecasts — no such views appear in this edition, for the reason set out below. Where sources conflict, the conflict is stated and left unresolved rather than reconciled by the editor. Figures described as this guide's own arithmetic are derived from the sourced inputs shown and are not published assessments.

Sources and update notes

(a) Internal. None. No Heyokha Wiki page, theme page, source-summary page or provider issue was used in this edition, because none could be retrieved. The Heyokha Wiki MCP server is installed on the account but was not enabled for this session, so `list_sources`, `list_pages` and `get_page` were unavailable and the entity-scoring and theme-ranking procedure that normally selects the topic could not be run. No `last_reviewed` date, no page creation date and no provider issue — 13D Research, White Box, Greed & Fear, Solid Ground, Marc Faber, HS Dent, Gary Shilling or any other — is cited anywhere above, because none was read. Any provider attribution in this edition would have been fabricated, and so none appears.

(b) Limitation on the internal view. The standing limitation of this section is normally provider concentration on a single Wiki page. Today the limitation is more severe and runs the other way: **this edition has no internal view at all**. It is entirely external reporting, which means it lacks the house's own framing, its prior positioning, its record of what it has already been wrong about on this theme, and the long-horizon provider perspective that usually supplies the contrarian counterweight. A reader should treat this as a briefing assembled from public sources, not as a Heyokha view, and should be aware that the reframe offered in the sidebar on page one is the editor's construction rather than a researched house position. The topic name "Oil Chokepoint Risk" is likewise the editor's, not a verified Wiki theme title.

(c) External sources. **1.** Brent \$88.79 and WTI \$83.47, both closing 11 August 2026 — Trading Economics. Brent \$72.48 on 27 February 2026; \$126.41 intraday and \$120.88 close on 30 April 2026; \$61.08 on 7 January 2026; monthly averages June \$85.40, July \$83.76 — [countrypeconomy.com](#) daily series and CNN/ABC7 reporting of 30 April 2026. **2.** Strait of Hormuz transit 4.9 mb/d in Q2 2026 against 21.6 mb/d in Q4 2025; Bab el-Mandeb 8.1 mb/d against 5.4 mb/d; global shut-ins averaging 5.5 mb/d in July 2026; Brent forecast \$85 in Q3 2026, \$78 in Q4 2026, \$69 average 2027; US crude production 13.8 mb/d in 2026 — EIA Short-Term Energy Outlook, released 11 August 2026, forecast closed 6 August. **3.** Hormuz normal transit 20.7 mb/d (2024) and LNG 11.4 Bcf/d — EIA World Oil Transit Chokepoints, 3 March 2026. **4.** 2026 demand contracting around 1.0 mb/d to 103.3 mb/d, first decline since 2020; 2027 demand 105.3 mb/d; Gulf exports 16.1 mb/d in June against a pre-war 24 mb/d; effective OPEC-8 spare capacity 0.04 mb/d — IEA Oil Market Report, July 2026, published 10 July 2026, with balance figures as reported by Argus the same day. The August report was scheduled for 12 August 2026 and was not public at the time of writing. **5.** 2026 demand growth +0.8 mb/d, 2027 +1.9 mb/d — OPEC Monthly Oil Market Report, July 2026, published 13 July 2026. The August report was also scheduled for 12 August and was not public. **6.** September production adjustment of 188 kb/d completing the rollback of the 1.65 mb/d April

2023 voluntary cuts — OPEC press release, 2 August 2026, and Oil & Gas Journal, 3 August 2026. **7.** VLCC TD3C \$481,286 a day, 7 August 2026 — Baltic Exchange. \$519,104 on 3 March, \$294,645 on 16 March and \$208,000 on 27 February 2026 — Platts VLCC index. 52-week average near \$100,000 — Signal Group weekly tanker monitor, week 14 2026. **8.** Baltic Dirty Tanker Index 2,644 on 10 August 2026, roughly double its level at the start of the year, against 3,723 on 30 March 2026 — Baltic Exchange data via StockQ and Signal Group. **9.** War-risk premium 3 to 10 per cent of hull value against 0.25 per cent in peacetime — Marcus Baker, Global Head of Marine at Marsh, quoted in The National, 17 July 2026. **10.** Iran's declaration of complete suspension of ship movement, 31 July 2026 — Iranian Persian Gulf waterways management organisation. Iran–Oman lanes agreed in principle 5–6 August 2026, unsigned as of 11 August — Bloomberg and Al Jazeera, 5–6 August 2026. Vessel transits of seven to eight a day in early August against roughly 130 before the crisis — Al Jazeera, 5 August 2026, and Windward, 9 August 2026. Transits down roughly 90 per cent year on year and about 70 per cent running dark — Lloyd's List Intelligence Hormuz briefs, 21 July and 5 August 2026. **11.** Saudi East-West pipeline running at 7 mb/d against a 5 mb/d design — Pipeline Technology Journal, 30 March 2026, and Fortune, 28 March 2026. UAE Habshan–Fujairah 1.5–1.8 mb/d with up to 0.7 mb/d spare — IEA, February 2026, and Al Jazeera, 15 May 2026. **12.** Company results: DHT Holdings Q2 2026, released 5 August 2026; International Seaways Q2 2026, released 6 August 2026 with the earnings call on 10 August; Teekay Tankers Q2 2026, released 29 July 2026; Frontline Q1 2026, released 22 May 2026, with Q2 due 31 August 2026; Shell Q2 2026, released 30 July 2026; Valero Q2 2026, released 30 July 2026 with the call transcript of the same date. All figures are the issuers' own. **13.** US 3:2:1 crack spread \$60.04 on 10 August 2026 — RBN Energy market data; record \$64.58 on 8 July 2026 — IndexBox, 11 July 2026. Global refining capacity down an estimated 4.5 mb/d in Q2 2026 — Forbes, 23 July 2026. **14.** Bear-case forecasts: Fitch Ratings, 8 August 2026 (roughly \$70 by Q4 2026, oversupply from September); Wood Mackenzie's Simon Flowers and Alan Gelder via Rigzone, 3 August 2026 (Brent well below \$60 into 2027 under a credible deal); BMI, 3 August 2026 (\$86 average 2026, \$71 in 2027); J.P. Morgan Global Research, 16 July 2026 (first surplus of about 1.2 mb/d in August; Gulf supply 90 per cent of pre-war in August, 97 per cent in October). **15.** US July CPI due 08:30 New York time, 12 August 2026, consensus 3.4 per cent headline; June 2026 headline –0.4 per cent on the month and +3.5 per cent on the year, energy –5.7 per cent on the month and +15.7 per cent on the year — Bureau of Labor Statistics, released 14 July 2026, and Kiplinger consensus, 11 August 2026. Fed funds target 3.50–3.75 per cent, held 29 July 2026 by 9–3 with three dissents in favour of a hike; next meeting 15–16 September 2026 — Federal Reserve, 29 July 2026.

(d) Editorial choices in this automated run. Three of the pipeline's normal steps failed and the consequences are worth stating plainly. **The archive could not be read.** The "HB Wiki Learning" desktop folder is reachable only through the remote-devices bridge, which is never connected for scheduled runs; no listing was possible and no filename could be parsed. The 30-day cooldown check therefore rests entirely on the two editions supplied in the standing instructions — AI Capex on 4 August and Gold Miners on 5 August 2026 — and cannot exclude the possibility that this theme, or a close neighbour, ran within the past month. **The Wiki could not be read.** The Heyokha Wiki MCP server was not enabled in this session, so the entity-scoring procedure over recent sources and the ranked list of active themes were both unavailable, and the topic could not be selected by the intended hot-first method. **The topic was therefore selected externally.** Oil chokepoint risk was chosen because it was demonstrably the live market question on the edition date: crude was the day's strongest mover, the Iran–Oman negotiation was unresolved, and both the IEA and OPEC monthly reports plus the US CPI print were scheduled for 12 August. It is not on the known cooldown list. Two further limitations: an August throughput figure for the strait does not exist in any official source, so the second-quarter average is used and labelled as such; and no published bank research decomposing the oil price into risk premium and fundamentals could be found, so no such decomposition is offered here. Share-price percentage moves for the tanker names were omitted rather than published, because the available sources mixed price-only and dividend-adjusted bases and the difference is material for companies distributing most of their earnings.